

A

Verb and noun collocations

collocation	example
go along with an idea / a view	I go along with your view that crime and poverty are linked.
be in (complete) agreement	We are in complete agreement over the question of drug abuse in athletics.
tend to agree/disagree	I tend to agree that parents often blame teachers for problems which start within the family.
share an opinion / a view	I share your opinion that sport is over-commercialised.
appreciate someone's point of view	I appreciate your point of view , but I still think you are overstating the problem.
see someone's point [understand their opinion]	I can see your point ; I've never thought of it in that way before.
enter into an argument	I'd prefer not to enter into an argument over the result of the elections.
differences arise/exist	Differences exist / have arisen between the unions and the management over how to solve the problem.
come to / reach a compromise	We disagree over what to do, but I'm sure we can come to / reach a compromise .
settle a dispute / your differences	The management and the union have finally settled their pay dispute . I'm sure we can settle our differences without damaging our friendship.
agree to differ [agree to have different opinions]	I don't think we will ever agree with each other. We'll just have to agree to differ .

B

Verb and adverb collocations

verb	adverb	example
agree	entirely/ wholeheartedly	I entirely agree with you on the question of nuclear waste.
agree	partly / up to a point	I agree up to a point , but I also think there are other important factors.
disagree	fundamentally/ totally/strongly	The two philosophers disagreed fundamentally over the effect of the environment on behaviour.

C

Adjective and noun collocations for disputes and strong disagreements

I've often disagreed strongly with Nancy but I've never had such a **head-on clash** with her before.
[disagreement where two people confront each other directly]

The **bitter dispute** between the two groups finally led to violence.

We had a very **heated argument** about immigration the other day.

Jeff and I had a **fundamental disagreement** over who should be the next Chair of the club.

D

Further collocations for agreeing and disagreeing

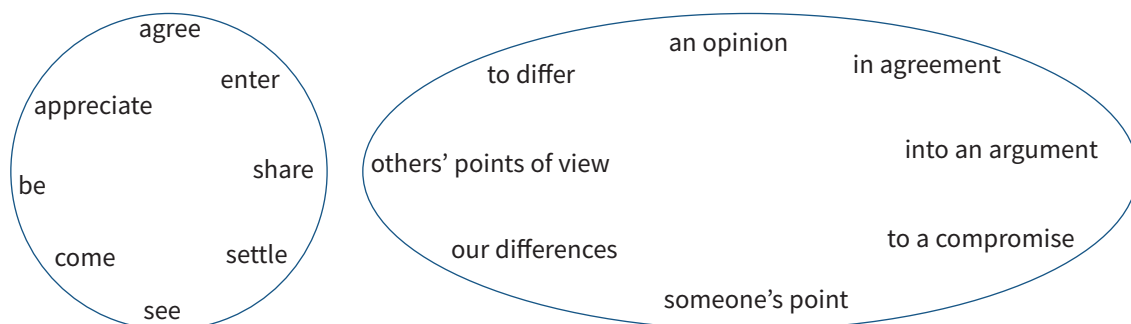
The Regional Education Committee has reached a **unanimous agreement** on a new system of exams for secondary schools.

Controversy continues to **exist/rage** over the appointment of the new Director.

A **conflict of opinion** within the National Olympic Association is threatening to delay the building of a new stadium.

Exercises

- 55.1** Look at A. Make collocations by matching words from the circle on the left with words from the oval on the right.



- 55.2** Put the expressions from the box into the appropriate category below.

a controversy rages	a head-on clash	a heated argument
settle a dispute	come to a compromise	differences exist

reaching agreement	disagreeing

- 55.3** Rewrite each sentence using the word in brackets, so that it keeps the same meaning.

- I don't completely agree with what you say. (POINT)
- I am in total agreement with you. (ENTIRELY)
- There was no disagreement among the committee members. (UNANIMOUS)
- There will always be differences of opinion even between friends. (ARISE)
- James and Ben had a big disagreement over the question of climate change. (STRONGLY)
- The project has been delayed because of the different opinions among the members of the committee. (CONFLICT)
- I find it difficult to agree with such an idea. (ALONG)
- We are in total disagreement about most things. (FUNDAMENTALLY)

- 55.4** Answer these questions about the collocations on the opposite page.

- Which collocation suggests that a disagreement is like a high temperature?
- Which two collocations suggest that a disagreement is like a fight or a war?
- Which collocation suggests that controversy is like anger?
- Why do you think the word *bitter* is used to refer to quarrels and disputes as well as to taste?
- Which collocation suggests that understanding someone's opinion is like using your eyes?